Install PadChat

One installer adds the WoW addon and its optional Windows voice companion.

01 DOWNLOAD AND INSTALL

Download PadChat-Setup.exe - click here

CurseForge downloads the addon only. For voice, use the installer above. No Python installation, API key or paid speech account is needed.

1. Close WoW and run Setup

   Download the installer, then run it with WoW closed. If you chose the complete Windows Voice ZIP instead, use Extract All first and run the extracted installer.

2. Choose your Forever game folder

   Use Browse and select the folder containing WowB.exe, usually World of Warcraft_classic_beta_. Do not choose Interface\AddOns or a new folder called Padchat.

3. Enable voice and install

   Keep Install voice typing checked. Choose whether to start the companion when you sign in to Windows, then click Install. Approve a folder-write permission prompt only if you intend to install there.

4. Select your microphone

   Choose your Windows headset or microphone and save. Close the companion microphone/binding windows afterwards; PTT is paused while those windows are open.

Folder example
E:\World of Warcraft_classic_beta_
Shared Data may remain in the parent folder. Do not move or copy it to fix setup.

Set up your controls

Choose the microphone and push-to-talk button from inside WoW.

02 ENABLE AND BIND

1. Enable the addon

   Start WoW. At character selection, open AddOns and enable PadChat. Disable older ControllerKeyboard addons and do not run a second voice helper.

2. Open PadChat Options

   Enter the world and click PadChat's controller/chat-bubble minimap icon. Keyboard users can type /padchat voice. Choose Voice settings > Guided setup.

3. Choose the microphone and PTT

   Set Voice: On. Choose your microphone, then click Bind push-to-talk and press your preferred key or middle/side mouse button. Default keyboard PTT is F8.

4. Choose controller voice controls

   Default controller PTT is Share / Create / Back, with Hold first: None. You can choose an optional held trigger/shoulder. Resolve binding-conflict notices before saving.

5. Save when safe

   Choose Save & reload UI, then reopen Voice settings. Pending choices are not active until saved and applied. The microphone must be available to Windows on the PC running the companion.

Controller-only opening
Native PlayStation: touchpad click opens the chat keyboard. Other controller identities get a first-use panel to choose an opening button. D-pad selects, X/A activates, Circle/B goes back. F9 is optional.

Try a safe voice test

Check recognition before sending a real message.

03 TEST AND USE

1. Keep Voice settings open

   Close normal chat/search boxes and finish binding capture. Choose Test microphone / check companion. Keep the in-game Voice panel open for the whole test.

2. Hold your saved PTT and speak

   Say a short phrase, then release. The test shows connection/loading feedback, a microphone level during recording and recognised words. No chat or invitations are sent.

3. Test both input types

   Try keyboard/mouse PTT and controller PTT separately. If a connection check fails before recording, that does not establish a microphone fault.

For a real message
Close Voice settings and select WoW.
Tap PTT: cycle destination. Hold: speak. Release: send.
Choose Say for your first message. Escape cancels dictation.

Prefer to check words before sending?
In Voice settings choose review, then press PTT again and Save & reload. After dictating, inspect the preview, then press PTT again to send. Escape or Circle/B cancels.

Using the on-screen keyboard
Open it with your saved control. D-pad/stick chooses a key and X/A selects. Send, Options and Close are selectable keys. Escape or Circle/B closes and preserves the draft.

Names and accuracy
WoW words / names accepts optional recognition hints. They do not guarantee corrections. Speech can mishear words or names; optional review lets you inspect the result.

If voice stops working

Restart the companion without closing your game.

04 RECOVER AND UPDATE

1. Check the saved setup

   Check Voice: On, the saved PTT and the intended microphone. Close Windows companion configuration windows and return focus to WoW.

2. Restart the companion

   When safe outside combat, open Voice settings and choose Restart voice + reload UI, then confirm. Or right-click PadChat beside the Windows clock and choose Restart voice. If the app is closed, open PadChat Voice from Windows Start.

3. Release, reconnect and retry

   Release PTT before pressing again. Reconnect the same saved headset. If choosing another input, select it in Voice settings and save when safe. Missing inputs do not silently switch to another mic.

4. Repair or update both parts

   If it still fails, close WoW and rerun the matching installer with voice enabled. Settings and other addons are preserved. CurseForge alone does not update the Windows companion.

Preview 8 installer and downloads

Full written setup guide

Report a problem / attach a video

Include this in a report
Addon/companion versions, controller model and USB/Bluetooth connection, saved PTT, microphone and exact error or failed step. Hide character names and private chats in images/videos.

Forever 1.60.x only. This is an unsigned preview. Automated shipping checks pass; broader physical-device, protected gameplay and fresh-PC acceptance remain incomplete. Connection status is the last acknowledged check, not a continuous guarantee.